The Rich Report

U.S. Economics News:

- **S&P 500 Earnings:** With 86 companies reported in Q1 2026, blended earnings growth stands at 12.9% year-over-year, slightly ahead of the 12.4% pre-season forecast, with 80.2% of companies posting positive surprises — on pace for the sixth consecutive quarter of double-digit earnings growth.[3]
- **Sector EPS Divergence:** Energy is the biggest FY26 earnings turnaround story, swinging from -12% growth in 2025 to an estimated +22% in 2026, while Communication Services decelerates sharply from 19% to a projected 5%, reflecting uneven sector-level recovery beneath the index headline.[3]
- **Semiconductor Record:** Global semiconductor sales hit a record $795.6 billion in 2025, up 26.2% year-over-year, with Asia Pacific leading regional growth at +45.0%. AI-driven demand has produced an estimated 88.9% earnings growth forecast for the semiconductor subsector in 2026 alone.[3]
- **Chip Supply Crunch:** A global memory chip shortage is expected to persist through 2027, with top U.S. and South Korean suppliers projected to cover only 60% of estimated demand, driving surging prices and sending the Philadelphia Semiconductor Index up 36.44% year-to-date through April 21.[3]
- **Housing Stagnation:** Existing home sales remain depressed as 30-year mortgage rates stay elevated amid the Iran conflict, which has shifted policy focus away from housing reform and reversed hopes for near-term rate relief, while active listing inventory continues to creep higher year-over-year.[3]
- **Macro Catalyst Week:** The week of April 28 is the most data-dense of the quarter, with the FOMC expected to hold rates at 3.75% (99.9% probability per Polymarket), Q1 advance GDP printing Thursday alongside March PCE, and five Magnificent 7 companies reporting — with hyperscaler capex guidance set to reprice the AI narrative.[3]

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Digital Assets News:

- **BTC/Dollar Inverse:** — Bitcoin's 30-day correlation with the U.S. Dollar Index has plunged to -0.90, its most negative reading since 2022, meaning the two assets are moving in near-perfect opposition. As the dollar strengthens on safe-haven demand or Fed hawkishness, Bitcoin sells off sharply — reinforcing the narrative that BTC trades more like a risk asset than a hedge against fiat debasement.[5]
- **Clearing Act Deadline:** — The Clarity Act confronts a hard political deadline around Memorial Day (May 25), after which the Senate Banking Committee would face near-impossible odds of advancing the bill as incumbents pivot to midterm campaigning. Missing this window likely shelves the legislation entirely until after the election cycle, potentially killing momentum built over months of bipartisan negotiation and industry lobbying.[5]

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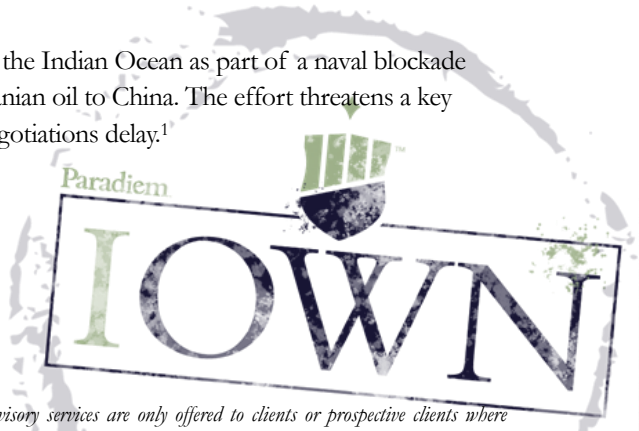
Geopolitics News:

- **Canada/US Trade:** Canadian Trade Minister LeBlanc confirmed that any USMCA renewal hinges on U.S. relief from sectoral tariffs currently sitting at up to 50% on steel, aluminum, and autos, while acknowledging he expects partial rather than full tariff elimination. Talks with Washington are described as slow-moving and difficult, with U.S. officials citing unresolved bilateral issues.[1]
- **EU:** The EU formally approved a €90 billion loan to Ukraine and a 20th sanctions package against Russia, breaking a months-long Hungarian veto after Kyiv completed repairs to the Druzhba pipeline. Separately, EU officials are seeking U.S. jet fuel imports and new reserve quotas to address supply pressure from the Hormuz closure, which affects 30-40% of Europe's jet fuel imports.[1]
- **Iran:** Iran is simultaneously seizing foreign vessels in the Strait of Hormuz, showcasing ballistic weapons, and — through Pakistani intermediaries — offering to reopen the strait if the U.S. lifts its naval blockade and ends the war, with nuclear talks deferred to a later phase. The offer is considered unlikely to satisfy Washington, which has continued boarding Iranian tankers in the Indian Ocean.[1]
- **Iraq:** The Trump administration blocked a nearly $500 million dollar shipment to Iraq's central bank and suspended some military training programs, pressuring Baghdad to dismantle Iranian-backed militias that have been attacking U.S. facilities in Iraq and the region since the war with Iran began.[1]
- **Japan:** Prime Minister Takaichi approved a sweeping overhaul of defense export rules, allowing sales of lethal weapons — including fighter jets, missiles, and warships — for the first time since Japan's postwar pacifist constitution took hold. The change is framed as both an economic growth measure and a response to the deteriorating security environment in which no single country can protect itself alone.[1]
- **US:** Trump ordered the Navy to shoot any vessel placing mines in the Strait of Hormuz and declared mine-clearing operations would be tripled. The Justice Department reclassified state-regulated marijuana from Schedule I to Schedule III, a significant legal shift that falls short of full legalization but opens the door for research and expanded medical access. Virginia voters narrowly approved a redistricting amendment allowing the Democrat-controlled legislature to redraw congressional maps, potentially flipping four Republican-held seats ahead of November midterms. The Supreme Court heard arguments over geofence warrants — law enforcement requests for location data from all phones near a crime scene — in a case that could reshape digital privacy protections. At the White House Correspondents' Dinner, a gunman was stopped at a security checkpoint; investigators found writings citing anti-Trump grievances.[1]
- **US/China/Iran:** U.S. forces boarded additional Iranian tankers in the Indian Ocean as part of a naval blockade targeting the shadow fleet of over 500 vessels that secretly ships Iranian oil to China. The effort threatens a key Iranian revenue stream that has helped sustain the war and fund negotiations delay.[1]



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The Good News:

- **Stroke Prevention:** A once-daily triple combination pill called GMRx2 reduced recurrent stroke risk by 39% in patients with intracerebral haemorrhage, according to a New England Journal of Medicine trial. Lowering blood pressure is the only proven prevention method, but complex drug regimens make adherence difficult — this single pill simplifies treatment for millions worldwide facing high risk of a second stroke.[2]
- **Clean Energy Milestone:** Renewables generated more electricity in 2025 than global demand growth required, according to energy think tank Ember. Solar expansion in China and India drove clean power output up by 887 terawatt hours, outpacing the 849 TWh rise in worldwide electricity consumption — marking the first time clean energy supply has structurally kept pace with growing global demand.[2]
- **Laser Breakthrough:** Physicists using the Gemini laser demonstrated relativistic harmonic generation, bouncing intense light off plasma moving at near-light speed to dramatically boost laser intensity. A focusing technique then concentrates multiple wavelengths into a tiny point. Published in Nature, the advance could enable experiments probing quantum electrodynamics — the fundamental theory governing how light and matter interact at the smallest scales.[2]
- **Nuclear Expansion:** The US Department of Energy's UPRISE program aims to add 5 GW of nuclear capacity by 2029 by uprating existing reactors and reactivating dormant facilities — equivalent to five new reactors at a fraction of new-build costs. Since the 1970s, 171 approved uprates have already added 8 GW, making reactor upgrades the fastest and most cost-effective path to expanding clean baseload power.[2]
- **Chip Miniaturisation:** A commercial chip-patterning system has etched structures just 8 nanometres wide on silicon — reportedly the smallest ever achieved in a single step by such a system. The technology could pack 2.9 times more transistors onto chips than previous-generation tools allowed, offering a concrete path to meeting surging AI computing demands without requiring entirely new manufacturing approaches.[2]

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Dividend Portfolio News:

- **DGX:** Quest Diagnostics beat Q1 estimates — EPS of $2.50 topped consensus by $0.13, revenue of $2.89B beat by $60M — and raised full-year guidance to revenue of $11.78B–$11.9B and adjusted EPS of $10.63–$10.83. Offsetting the positive results, Hedgeye added DGX as a new short idea.[4]
- **GPC:** Genuine Parts beat Q1 estimates (EPS $1.77, revenue $6.3B, +$140M vs. consensus) and reaffirmed full-year adjusted EPS guidance of $7.50–$8.00. Management confirmed the planned separation of its industrial and automotive businesses remains on track for Q1 2027, with $100M–$150M in targeted run-rate cost savings.[4]
- **LRCX:** Lam Research posted a strong fiscal Q3 — Non-GAAP EPS of $1.47 beat by $0.11, revenue of $5.84B beat by $80M — and raised its 2026 wafer fab equipment outlook to $140B with upside bias. June quarter guidance calls for EPS of $1.65 ±$0.15. The SOX index crossed 10,000 for the first time, reflecting broad semiconductor strength.[4]
- **LMT:** Lockheed Martin missed Q1 estimates (GAAP EPS $6.44, revenue $18.02B, both short of consensus) with weakness in Aeronautics and RMS segments. Full-year free cash flow guidance of $6.5B–$6.8B was maintained.[4]
- **NEE:** NextEra Energy surged to an all-time high after Q1 Non-GAAP EPS of $1.09 beat by $0.06. Revenue of $6.7B missed by $390M but profit more than doubled year-over-year. Management targets the high end of $3.92–$4.02 adjusted EPS for 2026 and outlined a massive $90B–$100B investment plan for FPL through 2032.[4]
- **ORI:** Old Republic missed Q1 estimates — Non-GAAP EPS of $0.68 missed by $0.11, revenue of $2.2B missed by $70M. Management guided for net investment income growth in the low-to-mid single digits for 2026 and is targeting a specialty expense ratio below 30%.[4]
- **SSNC:** SS&C Technologies beat Q1 estimates — Non-GAAP EPS of $1.69 beat by $0.04, revenue of $1.65B beat by $20M — and raised its full-year revenue outlook to $6.664B–$6.824B while forecasting adjusted EPS of $6.74–$7.06 for 2026.[4]
- **STLD:** Steel Dynamics surged to an all-time high after reporting rising Q1 profit and a positive outlook. Management targets exiting 2026 at 90% capacity at its new Aluminum Dynamics facility and reaffirmed $650M–$700M through-cycle EBITDA for that segment.[4]
- **TEL:** TE Connectivity posted mixed Q2 results — Non-GAAP EPS of $2.73 beat by $0.03, but revenue of $4.74B missed by $20M — sending shares lower. Q3 guidance calls for sales of ~$5B and adjusted EPS of ~$2.83, and management raised its AI revenue outlook by $150M, signaling continued strength in data center connectivity demand.[4]

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Growth Portfolio News

- **COIN:** Wisconsin DOJ sued Coinbase alongside Robinhood and others over sports betting markets. Separately, crypto markets saw broad movement, with tokenization deals like Chainlink's $11B copper-gold project highlighting blockchain's expanding use cases — relevant context for Coinbase's platform growth thesis.[4]
- **HRMY:** Harmony Biosciences spiked following new patent litigation around Wakix, its narcolepsy drug — litigation can signal defensive value of IP and deter generic competition.[4]
- **HUT:** Hut 8 announced a $3.25B notes offering to fund a major data center project, signaling aggressive capital deployment into AI infrastructure beyond its Bitcoin mining roots.[4]
- **NVDA:** A dense week for Nvidia: SA analyst upgraded the stock; Cohere (Nvidia-backed) acquired German AI startup Aleph Alpha; Pony AI launched an L4 robotaxi controller built on Nvidia tech; Oklo and Los Alamos partnered with Nvidia on nuclear-powered AI factories; Google's A5X scales to 960,000 Rubin GPUs. Dan Ives sees chips climbing 15% further. Big Tech earnings this week are a key near-term catalyst.[4]
- **SYF:** Synchrony Financial delivered a strong Q1 beat — GAAP EPS of $2.27 beat by $0.07, revenue of $4.77B beat by $1B — with declining credit loss provisions and a $6.5B buyback authorization. Dividend raised to $0.34/share next quarter. BTIG downgraded to Neutral, citing balanced risk/reward after the strong print.[4]
- **TOL:** Toll Brothers announced an acquisition of a homebuilder in northwest Arkansas, continuing its geographic expansion strategy into high-growth secondary markets.[4]
- **TSM:** TSMC hit a record high after Taiwan loosened fund investment limits. The company debuted its new A13 and N2U chip manufacturing technology, plans an Arizona chip packaging plant by 2029, and is holding off on ASML's newest EUV machines — a margin-positive decision per analysts. Google is reportedly eyeing MediaTek-TSMC collaboration for 8th-gen TPUs.[4]

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Summary:

In regard to the United States Economy, corporate earnings continue to impress, with Q1 2026 blended growth running at 12.9% year-over-year — on pace for a sixth consecutive quarter of double-digit gains. Semiconductors remain a standout, with global sales hitting a record $795.6 billion in 2025 and an ongoing memory chip shortage expected to persist through 2027. The week ahead is data-heavy, featuring the FOMC meeting, Q1 GDP, March PCE, and five Magnificent 7 earnings reports.

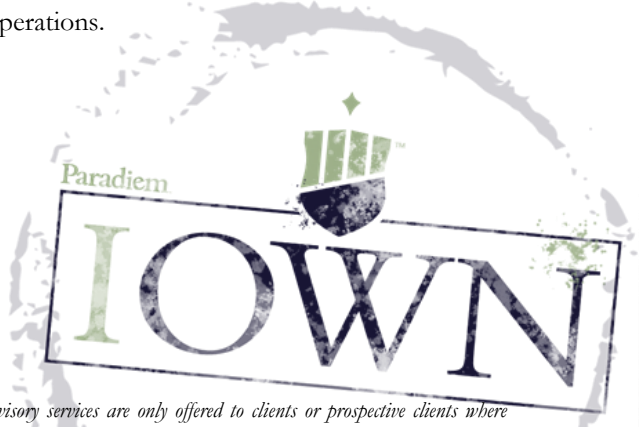
In the world of digital assets, Bitcoin's 30-day correlation with the U.S. Dollar Index has collapsed to -0.90, reinforcing its behavior as a risk asset rather than a fiat hedge. On the regulatory front, the Clarity Act faces a hard Memorial Day deadline in the Senate, after which advancing the legislation becomes politically unlikely as lawmakers shift attention toward midterm campaigns — potentially shelving months of bipartisan momentum.

Recently around the globe, the Iran conflict continues to dominate, with Tehran seizing vessels in the Strait of Hormuz while offering conditional negotiations through Pakistani intermediaries. The EU approved a €90 billion loan to Ukraine and a new sanctions package against Russia. Japan overhauled its postwar defense export rules to permit lethal weapons sales. Meanwhile, U.S.-Canada trade talks remain slow, and Washington pressured Baghdad to dismantle Iranian-backed militias operating in the region.

For the good news, a single combination pill reduced recurrent stroke risk by 39% in a major clinical trial, simplifying treatment for high-risk patients globally. Clean energy hit a structural milestone, with renewables generating more electricity in 2025 than total global demand growth required. Nuclear power expansion is accelerating through reactor uprates, and physicists achieved a laser breakthrough published in Nature that could unlock new frontiers in quantum physics research.

In the news for the dividend portfolio, NextEra Energy surged to an all-time high after doubling profits year-over-year, while Quest Diagnostics and SS&C Technologies both beat estimates and raised guidance. General Dynamics secured two new defense contracts, and Steel Dynamics also reached a record high on a strong earnings outlook. Lockheed Martin missed estimates but cited positive forward catalysts in F-35 and missile demand, and Lam Research raised its wafer fab equipment outlook to $140 billion.

And, for the growth portfolio, Nvidia remained central to the AI story as partner ecosystems expanded across robotaxi, nuclear-powered AI factories, and massive GPU deployments. TSMC hit a record high after debuting new chip manufacturing technology and loosened investment rules in Taiwan. Synchrony Financial delivered a strong earnings beat with a major buyback authorization, while Hut 8 announced a $3.25 billion capital raise targeting AI infrastructure development beyond its Bitcoin mining operations.



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